

inate bureaucracy. This shift has led to greater transparency,” Jain says. But he emphasises the need for enhanced measures to protect citizens from digital fraud and cybercrimes, especially in smaller towns.

There is also a need for a national security directive to prevent unapproved Chinese hardware in critical sectors like telecom and power and Jain feels there is a shortage of skilled labour in the cybersecurity sector.

The DPDP Act has, however, drawn criticism from data activists that it allows the government to use a citizen’s data indiscriminately.

‘DIY’-ING IT

Initiatives like Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat will continue to play a pivotal role in strengthening domestic tech manufacturing, particularly in critical sectors like

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semiconductors and electronics, especially if the government aims to reduce the dependency on imports and foster home-grown innovation. Prabhu Ram, Head of Industry Intelligence Group at marketing research and consulting firm CyberMedia Research emphasises the importance of attracting upstream players to bolster the domestic electronics manufacturing value chain.

“This will significantly strengthen electronics manufacturing, thereby enhancing the country’s competitiveness,” he says.

The government’s support in the past two terms has helped establish manufacturing capabilities and it needs to continue investing to reduce imports. Highlighting the requirements of the nascent drone sector, Ankit Mehta, CEO of drone maker ideaForge says, “Continued support for R&D with upfront investment and continued incentives for production and collaborations are needed.”

The emerging semiconductors space requires robust infrastructure and government support. Eswara Rao Nandam, CEO of chips manufacturer Polymatech Electronics, highlights the importance of a reliable gas supply infrastructure for the semiconductor industry. “Access to these resources is essential for a thriving semiconductor industry,” he says.

AI FOOT FORWARD

To establish itself as a leader in emerging technologies, India needs a clear AI strategy, which should balance innovation with regulation, ensure ethical and secure AI development, say experts. Jaspreet Bindra, AI expert and founder of consulting firm

Tech Whisperer Ltd, says India could adopt a unique approach, blending its success in digital public infrastructure with AI advancements. “We need a clear strategy that balances pro-innovation with regulation. Creating an AI agenda could bridge the digital divide,” Bindra proposes. He also emphasises the need for an AI ethics or AI regulation-oriented approach. “We need laws around issues like deepfakes and privacy,” Bindra says. He believes India should create its own laws. “The problems in India are unique, and so we should cater to [solving] those,” he adds.

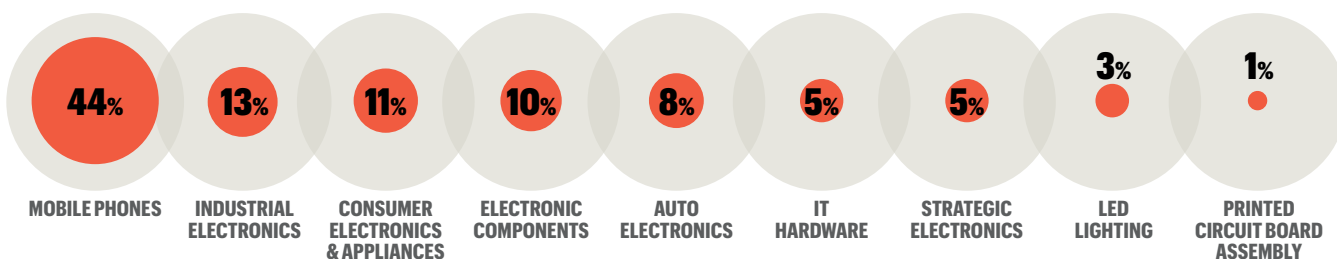
RIDING THE EV WAVE

Sustainability within the tech industry will be a priority, with initiatives aimed at promoting green tech and sustainable practices. This includes the adoption of energy-efficient solutions and reducing the carbon footprint of tech operations. The EV sector is poised for substantial growth, driven by government policies like the PLI scheme. However, further refinements are needed to keep up with technological advancements and market demands.

Maxson Lewis, CEO of EV solutions firm Magenta Mobility, underscores the importance of govern-

THE PRODUCTION PICTURE

● Initiatives like Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat will continue to play a crucial role in strengthening domestic tech manufacturing



NOTE DATA INDICATES SHARE IN PRODUCTION OF ELECTRONICS INDUSTRY; DATA FOR FY22 **SOURCE** MEITY